

YIFAN ZHAO

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EDUCATION

Colorado School of Public Health	Aurora, CO
M.S. in Biostatistics & Informatics	Dec 2025
Worcester Polytechnic Institute	Worcester, MA
M.S. in Bioinformatics & Computational Biology	2017
B.S. in Bioinformatics & Computational Biology — <i>with Distinction</i>	2015

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant , CIQI Lab — <i>Dr. Chuangqi Wang</i>	2025–2026
<i>University of Colorado Anschutz Medical Campus, Aurora, CO</i>	
- Analyzed dual scRNA-seq data from infected human cell lines to simultaneously profile host and intracellular bacterial transcriptomes. - Improved guinea pig genome annotation via orthology inference (TOGA) and validated the updated annotation on scRNA-seq data.	
Graduate Research Assistant , Center for Innovative Design & Analysis — <i>Dr. Mengli Xiao</i>	2024–2025
<i>Colorado School of Public Health, Aurora, CO</i>	
- Built a simulation causal-inference framework for a 16-variable clinical study. - Benchmarked a range of meta-analysis methods.	
Graduate Research Assistant , National Jewish Health — <i>Drs. Fingerlin & Moore</i>	2022–2024
<i>National Jewish Health, Denver, CO</i>	
Pre-processed bulk RNA-seq, methyl-seq, and WES data; ran differential-expression analyses and reported findings to collaborators.	

WORK EXPERIENCE

Bioinformatics Engineer , Sinotech Genomics — <i>Dr. Quanli Zou</i>	2019–2022
<i>Sinotech Genomics, Shanghai, China</i>	
- Built downstream scRNA-seq analysis pipelines for BD Rhapsody and 10× Genomics. - Trained team members in R, Linux, Git, and Anaconda. - Led “See-Cell,” an online single-cell data visualization tool built in R Shiny.	
Bioinformatics Engineer	Mar 2018–Dec 2018
<i>Shanghai Liangtai Biotechnology Co., Ltd., Shanghai, China</i>	
Helped develop an exome RNA-seq analysis pipeline under the supervision of Drs. Shuang Yang and Jue Fan.	

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant , Advanced Biostatistical Methods I (BIOS6618)	Fall 2024
<i>Colorado School of Public Health, Aurora, CO</i>	
- Graded homework assignments and identified potential areas of student difficulty. - Led lab sessions covering applied statistical methods.	

- Graded homework assignments and flagged recurring conceptual challenges for instructor review.

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Statistical Genomics Working Group

Fall 2023 – Spring 2026

Colorado School of Public Health, Aurora, CO | Department of Biostatistics & Informatics

- Organized and led monthly meetings as a department-affiliated working group (Fall 2023–2024); maintained the statistical-genomics mailing list.
- Served as **President** following transition to a formal student organization (Spring 2025).
- Served as **Treasurer** (Fall 2025–Spring 2026).

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Genomics: single-cell & bulk RNA-seq, differential expression, cell-type deconvolution, methyl-seq, WES

Languages & tools: R, R Shiny, Python, Linux/Bash, Git, Anaconda, AI-assisted dev (Claude Code)

Analysis: causal inference, meta-analysis, simulation